

120 million spread over the world in 50 countries, Microsoft has leveraged its presence in the e-mail segment (users can sign in using Hotmail, Messenger or Passport accounts). Very few social networking sites have such a ready-made pool. And unlike the majority of Microsoft's products, membership here is free. It was launched early in 2004.



the Windows Live Spaces homepage

Users not having the three sign in accounts can directly register for a hotmail account and sign in. The interface uses Silverlight technology and looks stunning. Best viewed with Internet Explorer 5 and above, this site has issues with other browsers like Firefox and Safari. Tabs from the homepage make for efficient navigation around the site. Moving around to different area and exploring the site makes it a fun experience in itself, probably because of the aesthetics.

Once you have your fill of looking at the eye candy on display you can get down to the business of editing your Space. You can import and synchronize your friend lists from Windows Live Messenger and Windows Live Mail. The people who are friends on Spaces automatically become friends on Messenger. If you are in a mood



Gadgets on Windows Live Spaces

to experiment further go ahead and fill your profile with bells and whistles. And there are lots to choose from. There are thousands of gadgets which do anything from predicting your future to showing the time of the day that you can add to your Spaces. Most of